

National Financial Services Commission

Circular NFSC/CIR/2025/02

To: All Licensed Microfinance Banks, Payment Service Providers and Mortgage Institutions | Date: 3 March 2025 | Status: In force

Amendment to the Cybersecurity and Operational Resilience Framework

1. Purpose

This circular amends Circular NFSC/CIR/2024/07. Provisions of the earlier circular not addressed here remain in force and unamended.

2. Amendment to incident reporting

Section 5 of Circular NFSC/CIR/2024/07 is amended. The notification window for a material cyber incident is reduced from seventy-two hours to **twenty-four hours** from detection. The threshold for financial loss constituting a material incident is reduced from NGN 10 million to **NGN 5 million**.

The requirement to submit a full incident report within fourteen days is unchanged.

3. Amendment to the implementation schedule

The compliance date for encryption of customer data at rest for institutions with total assets below NGN 5 billion is brought forward from 31 December 2025 to **30 September 2025**. All other dates in the schedule at section 6 of the earlier circular are unchanged.

4. New requirement: third-party concentration reporting

Institutions shall submit a return listing all outsourced technology providers supporting a critical business service, identifying for each provider the service supported, the jurisdiction in which data is processed, and the date of the most recent due diligence review. The first return is due 30 June 2025 and thereafter annually.

Where more than one institution within a group relies on the same provider for the same critical service, this shall be disclosed in the return.

5. Clarification: shared Chief Information Security Officer

The Commission has received enquiries regarding the shared officer arrangement permitted under section 3 of Circular NFSC/CIR/2024/07. For the avoidance of doubt, a shared arrangement may cover no more than three institutions, and the officer shall be resident in Nigeria.

6. Effective date

This circular takes effect from 1 April 2025.

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